



JQ

JOURNIQ AI

USER MANUAL

AI-powered Sri Lankan tourism platform

FOR

Tourists | Hotel Owners | Activity Providers | Administrators

VERSION

Project user guide

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Project: JourniQ AI - AI-powered Sri Lankan tourism platform

Purpose: JourniQ AI helps tourists discover Sri Lankan destinations, find hotels, book cultural/community experiences, receive personalized recommendations, use an AI trip planner, chat with providers, and manage their travel profile.

The platform also gives hotel owners and activity providers dashboards to manage listings, bookings, images, messages, revenue, and AI insights. Admins manage users, approvals, destinations, listings, analytics, reports, and system quality.

User Roles

JourniQ AI has four main user roles:

1. Tourist

Uses the public travel platform, receives recommendations, books hotels and experiences, chats with providers, and manages a personal travel profile.

2. Hotel Owner

Registers as a hotel partner, waits for admin approval, then manages hotel profile, rooms, images, availability, bookings, messages, revenue, and market insights.

3. Activity Provider

Registers as an activity provider, waits for admin approval, then manages local experiences, calendars, images, bookings, messages, community profile, revenue, and AI insights.

4. Admin

Manages platform approvals, users, hotels, experiences, bookings, destinations, analytics, AI monitoring, recommendation audit, reports, commission, help messages, and settings.

Main Website Access

Open the website in a browser:

```
http://localhost:3000
```

Main public pages:

- Home: <http://localhost:3000>
- Destinations: <http://localhost:3000/destinations>
- Hotels: <http://localhost:3000/hotels>
- Experiences: <http://localhost:3000/experiences>
- Recommendations: <http://localhost:3000/recommendations>
- AI Trip Planner: <http://localhost:3000/ai-trip-planner>
- AI Assistant: <http://localhost:3000/ai-assistant>
- Help: <http://localhost:3000/help>
- About: <http://localhost:3000/about>
- Contact: <http://localhost:3000/contact>

Tourist User Manual

Tourist Registration

1. Go to:
<http://localhost:3000/register>
2. Select Tourist.
3. Enter account details:
 - Name
 - Email
 - Password
 - Confirm password
 - Phone
 - Country
 - Accept terms acknowledgement
4. After account creation, the system asks travel preference questions one by one.
 5. Select preferences such as:
 - Travel interests
 - Preferred places
 - Activity types
 - Accommodation styles
 - Travel style
 - Budget
 - Travel pace
 6. Finish onboarding.
 7. The system saves preferences to personalize destinations, hotels, experiences, recommendations, and AI trip planning.
 8. A verification email is sent to the tourist email address.

Tourist Login

1. Go to:
<http://localhost:3000/login>
2. Enter email and password.
3. Click Login.
4. After successful login, the tourist is redirected to the tourist profile.

Email Verification

1. Open the verification email sent by JourniQ AI.
2. Click the Verify Email button.
3. The browser opens:

<http://localhost:3000/verify-email>

4. If the token is valid, the email is marked as verified.

5. If the link is expired, request a new verification email from the verify email page.

Forgot Password

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/forgot-password>

2. Enter the account email.

3. Click Send reset email.

4. Open the password reset email.

5. Click the reset link.

6. Enter a new password and confirm it.

7. Login again with the new password.

Tourist Profile

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/dashboard>

Tourists can:

- View profile details
- Update personal details
- View saved travel preferences
- See past behavior data
- Review recommendation signals
- Access AI profile
- Access messages
- Delete account if needed
- Logout

AI Profile

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/dashboard/ai-profile>

The AI profile shows:

- Tourist preference completeness
- Travel style
- Saved interests
- Saved districts
- Booking behavior
- Recommendation history
- Model-related recommendation details where available

Browse Destinations

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/destinations>

2. Search or filter destinations.

3. Open a destination card.

4. View the destination blog/details page.

5. Personalized destination ranking is influenced by the tourist preferences.

Browse Hotels

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/hotels>

2. Search hotels by location and travel details.

3. Use filters if available.

4. Click a hotel card to open the hotel details page.

5. Review:

- Hotel gallery
- Description
- Location
- Facilities
- Rooms
- Room images
- Prices in Sri Lankan Rupees

6. Click Book Now or Request Booking.

7. Select dates, guests, and room details.

8. Submit the booking request.

9. The hotel owner receives an email and chat notification.

10. The tourist receives a booking request confirmation email.

Browse Experiences

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/experiences>

2. Search and filter experiences.

3. Click an experience card to open the details page.

4. Review:

- Image gallery
- Description
- Category
- Location
- Duration
- Group size

- Included items
 - Safety notes
 - Price in Sri Lankan Rupees
5. Submit a booking request.
 6. The activity provider receives an email and chat notification.
 7. The tourist receives a booking request confirmation email.

Recommendations

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/recommendations>

Tourists can:

- View personalized recommendations
- Filter recommendation types
- Search by destination or budget
- View why an item is recommended
- Open hotels or experiences
- Book recommended items

Recommendations are based on:

- Registration preferences
- Recommendation searches
- Trip planner inputs
- Booking behavior
- Destination/activity/category matches

AI Trip Planner

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/ai-trip-planner>

Steps:

1. Select destination.
2. Enter travel dates.
3. Choose number of travelers.
4. Enter budget.
5. Choose interests.
6. Select travel pace.
7. Choose accommodation preference.
8. Select activities.
9. Enter starting location.
10. Add special notes.

After submitting, the system generates a trip plan interface using the current project API behavior.

Trip planner inputs are saved to improve future personalization for logged-in tourists.

AI Assistant

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/ai-assistant>

The AI assistant can help tourists:

- Find hotels
- Find experiences
- Ask about destinations
- Ask for Sri Lanka travel suggestions
- Receive listing links from current platform data

The assistant uses existing JourniQ AI data first.

Messages

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/dashboard/messages>

Tourists can:

- Chat with hotel owners after a hotel inquiry or booking request
- Chat with activity providers after an experience inquiry or booking request
- Continue real-time conversations
- View booking-related messages

Help Page

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/help>

Tourists can:

- Ask for platform help
- Contact support/admin through the help flow
- Review common support topics

Hotel Owner User Manual

Hotel Owner Registration

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/register/hotel-owner>

2. Enter:

- Owner name
- Email
- Password
- Phone
- Country
- District
- Hotel/business name
- Business registration number

3. Submit the application.

4. The owner receives an email confirming the application.

5. The admin receives an email notification.

6. The account remains pending until admin approval.

Hotel Owner Login

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/login/hotel-owner>

2. Enter email and password.

3. If account is pending, login is blocked until admin approval.

4. After approval, login redirects to:

<http://localhost:3000/hotel-owner/dashboard>

Hotel Owner Dashboard

Hotel owners can access:

- Dashboard
- Hotel Profile
- Rooms
- Bookings
- Messages
- Availability
- Revenue
- Market Insights
- Settings

Hotel Profile Management

Hotel owners can:

- Update hotel name
- Update address and district
- Add hotel category
- Add long description
- Add facilities and amenities
- Upload up to 15 hotel photos
- Remove photos
- Set preview image
- Save updated hotel details

Hotel images are uploaded through Cloudinary.

Room Management

Hotel owners can:

- Add rooms
- Edit rooms
- Add room type
- Add room description
- Add price per night
- Add capacity
- Add available room count
- Add room amenities
- Upload up to 5 room photos
- Remove room photos
- Activate or update room status

Booking Management

Hotel owners can:

- View booking requests
- Confirm bookings
- Reject bookings
- Mark bookings as completed
- See guest name, room type, dates, and amount

When booking status changes, the tourist receives an email notification.

Messages

Hotel owners can:

- Chat with tourists who sent booking requests or inquiries
- Reply in real time

- Continue conversations from the messages dashboard

Revenue

Hotel owners can:

- View total revenue
- View platform commission
- View net earnings
- View monthly revenue charts
- View completed bookings

Market Insights

Hotel owners can:

- View demand signals
- View listing quality score
- View pricing and trend suggestions
- See AI-related provider insights where available

Activity Provider User Manual

Activity Provider Registration

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/register/activity-provider>

2. Enter:

- Contact name
- Email
- Password
- Phone
- Country
- District
- Provider/business name
- Main activity category

3. Submit application.

4. The provider receives an email confirmation.

5. Admin receives an email notification.

6. Account remains pending until admin approval.

Activity Provider Login

1. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/login/activity-provider>

2. Enter email and password.

3. If account is pending, login is blocked.

4. After approval, login redirects to:

<http://localhost:3000/activity-provider/dashboard>

Activity Provider Dashboard

Activity providers can access:

- Dashboard
- Experiences
- Bookings
- Messages
- Calendar
- Revenue
- Community Profile
- AI Insights
- Settings

Experience Management

Activity providers can:

- Create experiences
- Edit experience details
- Add title
- Add category
- Add district and location
- Add description
- Add price
- Add duration
- Add maximum guests
- Add included items
- Add safety notes
- Upload up to 15 experience photos
- Remove photos
- Set main image

Experience images are uploaded through Cloudinary.

Booking Management

Activity providers can:

- View tourist booking requests
- Confirm bookings
- Reject bookings
- Mark bookings as completed
- See date, guests, total amount, and experience title

When booking status changes, the tourist receives an email notification.

Calendar

Activity providers can:

- Add calendar availability
- Block dates
- View upcoming bookings
- Manage experience scheduling

Messages

Activity providers can:

- Chat with tourists who requested an experience
- Reply in real time
- Continue booking-related conversations

Revenue

Activity providers can:

- View revenue
- View platform commission
- View net earnings
- View monthly breakdown
- View completed experiences

AI Insights

Activity providers can:

- View listing quality
- View category demand
- View pricing and market signals
- See AI-based improvement suggestions where available

Admin User Manual

Admin Login

1. Seed an admin from backend if needed:

```
cd /Users/yasiru_nisal/Desktop/research/backend  
npm run seed:admin
```

2. Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/login/admin>

3. Enter admin email and password.

4. After login, admin is redirected to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/dashboard>

Admin Dashboard

Admins can view:

- Platform overview
- Total users
- Total hotels
- Total experiences
- Total bookings
- Revenue summaries
- Pending approvals
- Recent bookings
- AI model health

Provider Account Approvals

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/approvals>

Admins can:

- View pending hotel owner accounts
- View pending activity provider accounts
- Approve provider accounts
- Reject/block provider accounts

When approved or rejected, the provider receives an email notification.

Hotel Listing Management

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/hotels>

Admins can:

- Search hotels
- Filter by status

- Filter by district
- Filter by category
- Approve hotel listings
- Reject hotel listings
- Suspend hotel listings

After approval:

- Approve button becomes disabled
- Hotel owner receives an email
- Approved hotels appear on the public hotel page

Experience Listing Management

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/experiences>

Admins can:

- Search experiences
- Filter by status
- Filter by district
- Filter by category
- Approve experiences
- Reject experiences
- Suspend experiences
- Feature active experiences

After approval or activation:

- Approve button becomes disabled
- Activity provider receives an email
- Approved/active experiences appear on the public experiences page

Destination Management

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/destinations>

Admins can:

- Add destinations
- Edit destinations
- Delete destinations
- Add destination image
- Add category, province, district, tags, and interests
- Add best time to visit
- Add blog title and excerpt
- Add blog post HTML and CSS
- Publish or save as draft

Published destinations appear on the public destinations page and can be recommended to tourists based on preferences.

Booking Management

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/bookings>

Admins can:

- View hotel bookings
- View activity bookings
- Filter by booking type
- Filter by status
- Review commission and provider earnings

User Management

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/users>

Admins can:

- Search users
- Filter by role
- Filter by status
- Block users
- Unblock users
- Delete non-admin users

Analytics

Admins can view:

- Tourist source markets
- Monthly bookings
- Revenue by category
- Hotels by district
- Experience bookings by category
- Tourism demand analytics
- AI model monitoring
- Recommendation audit
- Data quality reports

Commission

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/commission>

Admins can:

- View platform commission rows
- View hotel/activity booking commission
- View provider earnings

Reports

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/reports>

Admins can:

- Review report summaries
- View platform performance data
- Use analytics for project reporting

Help Inbox

Go to:

<http://localhost:3000/admin/help>

Admins can:

- View help messages
- Respond to user support needs where configured
- Monitor user support flow

Email Behavior

Emails are sent for:

- Tourist verification
- Password reset
- Provider registration
- Admin provider registration notification
- Provider account approval
- Provider account rejection
- Hotel listing approval/rejection
- Experience listing approval/rejection
- Booking request confirmation
- Booking request notification to provider
- Booking status updates

If an email is not received:

1. Check spam folder.
2. Confirm backend is running.
3. Confirm Gmail SMTP works:

```
cd /Users/yasiru_nisal/Desktop/research/backend  
npm run test:email -- your-email@gmail.com
```

4. Confirm backend/.env has:

```
EMAIL_USER  
EMAIL_APP_PASSWORD  
EMAIL_FROM  
FRONTEND_URL
```

5. Restart backend after changing .env.

Image Upload Behavior

Images are uploaded through Cloudinary.

Hotel owners can upload:

- Up to 15 hotel images
- Up to 5 images per room

Activity providers can upload:

- Up to 15 experience images
- Up to 15 community/profile images where supported

If images do not upload:

1. Check Cloudinary variables in backend/.env.
2. Restart backend.
3. Confirm selected files are valid images.
4. Check backend terminal for upload errors.

Chat Behavior

JourniQ AI supports real-time chat using Socket.IO.

Chat starts when:

- Tourist sends a hotel booking request
- Tourist sends an experience booking request
- Tourist opens provider-related messages
- Help conversation is created where supported

Users can access messages from:

- Tourist: /dashboard/messages
- Hotel owner: /hotel-owner/messages
- Activity provider: /activity-provider/messages

Ai Personalization Behavior

Tourist personalization uses:

- Registration preference answers
- Saved tourist preferences
- Recommendation searches
- Trip planner inputs
- Hotel booking behavior
- Experience booking behavior
- Last booked districts
- Last booked categories

Personalized outputs appear in:

- Recommendations page
- Destinations page
- AI profile
- AI trip planner behavior
- AI assistant suggestions

Security Notes

- Admin registration is disabled publicly.
- Provider accounts must be approved before login.
- JWT authentication protects dashboards.
- Role-based routes separate tourists, hotel owners, activity providers, and admins.
- Password reset uses secure temporary tokens.
- Email verification uses secure temporary tokens.
- Secrets must stay in .env files, not frontend code.

Logout

Users can logout from:

- Public navbar account menu
- Dashboard/profile pages
- Role dashboard navigation where available

After logout, the local token is removed and the user must login again.

Support / Troubleshooting

Tourist cannot login

- Check email and password.
- Use forgot password if needed.
- Confirm backend is running.

Provider cannot login

- Provider account may still be pending.
- Admin must approve the account first.

Hotel or experience does not appear publicly

- Admin must approve the hotel/experience listing.
- Check listing status in admin panel.

Booking email not received

- Check Gmail SMTP settings.
- Run backend email test.
- Check spam folder.

Chat not updating

- Confirm backend Socket.IO server is running.
- Confirm frontend socket URL points to backend.

AI recommendations feel empty

- Complete tourist onboarding preferences.
- Use trip planner once.
- Search recommendations with interests/district/budget.
- Add approved hotels, experiences, and destinations.